

2026

Social & Modern Studies

Grade 9 NCE — **Paper 4 of 4**

Focus: Regional & International Organisations • Contemporary World Issues

Duration: 2 hours **Total Marks:** 100

Candidate Name: _____

Class / Form: _____ Index No.: _____

Instructions to Candidates

1. This paper has **four sections**: A, B, C, and D.
2. Answer **ALL** questions in Sections A, B, and D.
3. In Section C, answer **ALL THREE** structured questions.
4. Write your answers in the spaces provided.
5. For Section A, tick (✓) **ONE** box only per question.
6. Use blue or black ink. Pencil may be used for diagrams only.
7. The marks for each question are shown in brackets [].
8. Calculators are **NOT** permitted.

Section	A — MCQ	B — Source	C — Structured	D — Essay	Total
Maximum marks	20	30	30	20	100
Marks scored					

SECTION A — Multiple Choice Questions [20 marks — 1 mark each] Tick ONE box only per question.

1. The African Union (AU) was established in which year? [1]
- ☐ A 1963
- ☐ B 1991
- ☐ C 2002
- ☐ D 2010
2. The African Union replaced which predecessor organisation? [1]
- ☐ A The Organisation of African Unity (OAU)
- ☐ B The Southern African Development Community (SADC)
- ☐ C The Common Market for Eastern and Southern Africa (COMESA)
- ☐ D The League of Arab States
3. The primary aim of the Southern African Development Community (SADC) is to: [1]
- ☐ A Establish a single military force for southern Africa
- ☐ B Promote sustainable and equitable economic growth and regional integration in southern Africa
- ☐ C Control oil and mineral resources on behalf of member states
- ☐ D Manage migration between African countries
4. Mauritius is a member of which of the following regional organisations? (Select ALL that apply — one option lists two correct memberships) [1]
- ☐ A SADC and COMESA
- ☐ B ECOWAS and IGAD
- ☐ C ASEAN and APEC
- ☐ D NATO and the European Union
5. The United Nations was founded in: [1]
- ☐ A 1919
- ☐ B 1945
- ☐ C 1948
- ☐ D 1955
6. The UN Security Council has the primary responsibility for: [1]

- ☐ A Approving the UN budget and managing finances
- ☐ B Maintaining international peace and security
- ☐ C Setting global trade rules and tariffs
- ☐ D Promoting cultural exchange between member states

7. Decolonisation refers to:

[1]

- ☐ A The expansion of European empires in the 19th century
- ☐ B The process by which colonies gained independence from colonial powers
- ☐ C The establishment of new colonies in the 20th century
- ☐ D The economic rebuilding of Europe after World War II

8. The Cold War (approximately 1947–1991) was a period of:

[1]

- ☐ A Hot military conflict between the USA and Soviet Union
- ☐ B Political, ideological, and military rivalry between the USA and USSR without direct armed conflict between them
- ☐ C Economic cooperation between Western Europe and the United States
- ☐ D Environmental competition to develop nuclear energy

9. The 'Non-Aligned Movement' during the Cold War consisted of:

[1]

- ☐ A Countries allied with the USA in NATO
- ☐ B Countries allied with the Soviet Union in the Warsaw Pact
- ☐ C Developing nations that chose not to formally align with either superpower bloc
- ☐ D European nations that refused to join the United Nations

10. Apartheid in South Africa was a system of:

[1]

- ☐ A Land reform that redistributed farmland to Black South Africans
- ☐ B Racial segregation and discrimination institutionalised by the government
- ☐ C Economic sanctions imposed by the international community
- ☐ D Democratic elections in which all citizens could vote

11. Which of the following was a direct consequence of the Cold War for many African nations?

[1]

- ☐ A Rapid economic development due to superpower investment
- ☐ B Proxy conflicts in which the USA and USSR supported opposing sides in civil wars
- ☐ C Immediate democratic governance and human rights protections
- ☐ D Peaceful independence movements with no external interference

12. The Agenda 2063 vision adopted by the African Union aims to: [1]
- ☐ A Unite all African countries under a single government by 2063
 - ☐ B Build a prosperous, integrated, and peaceful Africa driven by its own citizens by 2063
 - ☐ C Eliminate all external trade and achieve full autarky for Africa
 - ☐ D Establish Africa as a nuclear power by 2063
13. UN peacekeeping operations are deployed to: [1]
- ☐ A Invade and conquer countries that violate international law
 - ☐ B Help countries torn by conflict to create conditions for lasting peace
 - ☐ C Collect taxes from member states to fund UN programmes
 - ☐ D Enforce trade sanctions against sanctioned countries
14. International terrorism as a contemporary world issue is characterised by: [1]
- ☐ A Armed conflicts between the armies of two nations
 - ☐ B The use of violence and intimidation by non-state actors to pursue political, religious, or ideological goals
 - ☐ C Peaceful protests against government policies
 - ☐ D Economic competition between developed and developing nations
15. The COVID-19 pandemic (2020–2022) demonstrated which of the following about contemporary global challenges? [1]
- ☐ A Health crises affect only developing countries
 - ☐ B Crises can be fully managed by individual nations without international cooperation
 - ☐ C Global challenges require coordinated international responses and expose existing inequalities
 - ☐ D Globalisation has no effect on the spread of disease
16. Forced migration (refugees) is most commonly caused by: [1]
- ☐ A People choosing to live in a different country for lifestyle reasons
 - ☐ B Conflict, persecution, environmental disasters, and human rights abuses
 - ☐ C Government incentives to attract skilled workers
 - ☐ D Better educational opportunities abroad
17. The principle of 'national sovereignty' in international relations means: [1]
- ☐ A Powerful nations have the right to govern weaker nations
 - ☐ B Each nation has supreme authority over its own territory and affairs
 - ☐ C International organisations can overrule national laws at any time

☐ D Nations must share their resources equally with their neighbours

18. The African Continental Free Trade Area (AfCFTA), launched in 2021, aims to: [1]

- ☐ A Establish a common African currency replacing national currencies
- ☐ B Create a single continental market for goods and services across Africa
- ☐ C Allow free movement of all people across Africa without passports
- ☐ D Restrict trade between African and non-African countries

19. Neo-colonialism refers to: [1]

- ☐ A The formal military reoccupation of former colonies
- ☐ B The continuation of political or economic control over developing nations through indirect means after formal independence
- ☐ C A new wave of European colonisation in the 21st century
- ☐ D The process by which former colonies colonise other nations

20. The United Nations General Assembly differs from the UN Security Council in that: [1]

- ☐ A Only the General Assembly can declare war on behalf of the UN
- ☐ B The General Assembly includes all UN member states with one vote each and passes resolutions by majority, while the Security Council has 15 members with 5 permanent veto powers
- ☐ C The General Assembly manages UN peacekeeping forces directly
- ☐ D Only the Security Council can create new international laws

SECTION B — Source-Based Questions [30 marks] Answer ALL questions in this section.

SOURCE A

The African Union (AU) was established in 2002 to replace the Organisation of African Unity (OAU), which was founded in 1963. The OAU focused primarily on achieving independence for African colonies and opposing apartheid in South Africa. Once these goals were largely achieved, African leaders recognised the need for a new organisation that could address the continent's development challenges, promote good governance, and prevent conflicts. The AU's founding document, the Constitutive Act, commits member states to the promotion of democratic principles, human rights, the rule of law, and sustainable development. Key AU institutions include the Assembly of Heads of State, the Commission (its executive body), the Peace and Security Council, and the Pan-African Parliament. The AU's Agenda 2063 vision describes Africa as "The Africa We Want" — a prosperous, integrated, peaceful, and democratic continent driven by its own citizens and able to take its rightful place in the global community.

Adapted from: African Union Commission, AU Overview Document, 2023

21.

- (a) Using Source A, state **TWO** reasons why the Organisation of African Unity (OAU) was replaced by the African Union (AU).

[2]

- (b) Using Source A, describe the main goals and principles that guide the African Union. Explain why these are important for Africa's development.

[4]

- (c) Using Source A and your own knowledge, assess the challenges the African Union faces in achieving its Agenda 2063 goals.

[4]

SOURCE B

Table: SADC — Selected Regional Integration Indicators (2023)

Indicator	Value
Number of SADC member states	16
Combined population	~370 million
Combined GDP (USD trillion)	~0.9
Intra-SADC trade as % of total SADC trade	~18%
SADC free trade area in force since	2008
Active SADC peacekeeping deployments (2023)	2 (Mozambique, DRC)
Mauritius membership since	1995

Source: SADC Secretariat, *Regional Indicative Strategic Development Plan, 2023*

22.

- (a) Using Source B, state **TWO** facts about SADC that demonstrate the scale of this regional organisation.

[2]

- (b) Using Source B, explain what the data on intra-SADC trade suggests about the current level of regional economic integration. What does this imply for the future?

[4]

- (c) Using Source B and your own knowledge, explain the benefits of Mauritius's membership in SADC. How does it support Mauritius's economic and political interests?

[4]

SOURCE C

"The world today faces a set of interconnected challenges that no single nation can solve alone. Climate change threatens the stability of ecosystems and livelihoods globally, with small island developing states facing existential risks. The COVID-19 pandemic exposed deep inequalities in access to healthcare, vaccines, and economic support between wealthy and developing nations. Conflicts in various regions continue to displace millions of people, creating the largest refugee crisis since World War II. Terrorism, cyber-attacks, and the spread of disinformation threaten the security of democratic institutions. Meanwhile, rising nationalism and geopolitical competition between major powers such as the United States and China have weakened multilateral institutions and made international cooperation more difficult. The lesson of the 21st century is clear: global problems require global solutions, and institutions like the United Nations must be strengthened, reformed, and made more representative to meet these challenges effectively."

Adapted from: UN Secretary-General's Report on Global Challenges, 2024

23.

- (a) Using Source C, identify **TWO** contemporary global challenges mentioned in the source.

[2]

- (b) Using Source C, explain how the COVID-19 pandemic demonstrated global inequality. What does this suggest about the international community's response to global crises?

[4]

- (c) Using Source C and your own knowledge, explain what reforms to the United Nations might help it to be more effective in addressing 21st century global challenges.

[4]

SECTION C — Structured Essay Questions [30 marks] Answer ALL THREE questions.

- 24. Describe the role of the African Union (AU) in promoting peace, security, and development in Africa.**

[10]

In your answer, refer to: the AU's founding aims; its peace and security mechanisms; its development agenda (Agenda 2063); and specific examples of AU action.

- 25. Explain the significance of decolonisation for African nations and discuss the long-term challenges that emerged after independence.**

[10]

Consider: what colonialism was; why decolonisation was important; the challenges of nation-building; the legacy of colonial boundaries and institutions; Cold War interference; and the concept of neo-colonialism.

26. Discuss how the United Nations addresses contemporary global challenges such as climate change, forced migration, and international terrorism.

[10]

Refer to: specific UN bodies or programmes; examples of UN action; the strengths and limitations of the UN's approach; and what more could be done.

SECTION D — Extended Writing and Evaluation [20 marks] Answer the COMPULSORY question below.

- 27. "Regional integration through organisations such as SADC is the most effective way for African nations to achieve sustainable development."**

[20]

Using your knowledge and the evidence from Section B, write a well-organised essay in which you:

- Define regional integration and explain how SADC promotes it in southern Africa
- Analyse the ways in which SADC membership supports sustainable development for its member states, including Mauritius
- Analyse the limitations of SADC and regional integration as a development strategy
- Consider other approaches to development (e.g. national policy, AU, global partnerships) and evaluate whether regional integration is truly the most effective method

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Mark Scheme — Paper 4: Regional Organisations / Contemporary World Issues

This mark scheme provides **indicative content**. Credit any well-reasoned response that demonstrates knowledge and understanding. Exact wording is not required.

Section A — MCQ Answers

1. C — 2002 2. A — OAU 3. B — Sustainable equitable economic growth and integration 4. A — SADC and COMESA 5. B — 1945 6. B — Maintaining international peace and security 7. B — Colonies gained independence 8. B — Ideological and military rivalry without direct armed conflict 9. C — Developing nations not aligned with either superpower 10. B — Racial segregation institutionalised by government	11. B — Proxy conflicts 12. B — Prosperous, integrated, peaceful Africa by 2063 13. B — Help countries create conditions for lasting peace 14. B — Violence by non-state actors for political/religious/ideological goals 15. C — Global challenges require coordinated responses 16. B — Conflict, persecution, environmental disasters 17. B — Supreme authority over own territory 18. B — Single continental market 19. B — Continuation of control through indirect means after independence 20. B — All member states one vote, Security Council 15 members with 5 vetoes
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Q	Indicative Content	Marks
21(a)	Any TWO from Source A: OAU's main goals (independence, anti-apartheid) were achieved, so a new agenda was needed; need to address development challenges; need to promote good governance; need to prevent conflicts. Award 1 mark each.	2
21(b)	Goals from Source A: democratic principles, human rights, rule of law, sustainable development, peace and security, economic integration. Importance: democracy prevents conflict and promotes stability; human rights protect citizens; sustainable development raises living standards; integration creates larger markets. Award marks for identifying goals with explanation of importance.	4
21(c)	Challenges: political will — member states reluctant to cede sovereignty; funding — AU relies on member contributions and external donors; implementation gap — decisions made but not enforced; conflicts — ongoing in DRC, Sudan, Sahel; corruption and weak governance in some states; slow progress on Agenda 2063 targets. Award marks for specific, accurate challenges with some attempt to explain why they are difficult to overcome.	4
22(a)	Any TWO: 16 member states; combined population ~370 million; combined GDP ~\$0.9 trillion; free trade area since 2008; peacekeeping in Mozambique and DRC. Award 1 mark each with appropriate data reference.	2
22(b)	Intra-SADC trade at ~18% is relatively low (compared to e.g. intra-EU trade of ~60%); suggests integration is still limited	4

	despite FTA since 2008; infrastructure gaps, non-tariff barriers, and low productive capacity limit trade; implication — there is significant room for growth if integration deepens; AfCFTA may help; investment in transport/logistics needed. Award marks for analysis of what 18% means, not just stating the figure.	
22(c)	Benefits for Mauritius: access to southern African market for exports; preferential trade terms reduce costs; platform for diplomatic engagement; peacekeeping cooperation; investment flows. Political interest: regional voice and legitimacy; collective bargaining in global forums. Award marks for specific benefits linked to Mauritius's economic profile (financial services hub, tourism, textiles) and geographic position.	4
23(a)	Any TWO from Source C: climate change; COVID-19 pandemic inequalities; conflict and refugee crises; terrorism; cyber-attacks; disinformation; geopolitical competition weakening multilateralism. Award 1 mark each.	2
23(b)	COVID exposed: wealthy nations secured vaccines first; developing nations faced 'vaccine apartheid'; economic support packages much larger in rich countries; supply chain disruptions hit poorer nations harder. Implication: international community must reform global health architecture; COVAX mechanism insufficient; need for more equitable IP regimes; need for manufacturing capacity in developing regions. Award marks for specific evidence plus clear implication for international response.	4
23(c)	Reforms: expand Security Council to include African, Latin American, and Asian permanent members (UNSC reform); make UNGA resolutions more binding; create a UN emergency fund with guaranteed contributions; strengthen UN Environment Programme mandate; invest in UN mediation capacity; reform WHO governance after COVID; address geopolitical vetoes that block action. Award marks for specific reform suggestions with explanation of how each would improve effectiveness.	4
24	Band 4 (8–10): Detailed account of AU history, key institutions (Peace and Security Council, Commission, Pan-African Parliament), Agenda 2063 vision, specific examples of AU peacekeeping (AU Mission in Somalia/AMISOM, SADC deployments, interventions in crises). Content: founded 2002; replaced OAU; Constitutive Act principles; Agenda 2063 "Africa We Want"; PSC can authorise peacekeeping; AU observer missions; economic integration goals; challenges to effectiveness.	10
25	Content: Colonialism — European control of African territories for resources and labour; decolonisation significance — self-determination, national identity, end of racial hierarchy. Post-independence challenges: arbitrary colonial borders creating ethnic tensions; institutional inheritance (legal/administrative systems from colonisers); Cold War — USA and USSR backed rival factions in civil wars (Angola, Mozambique, DRC/Zaire); lack of industrialisation; neo-colonialism — economic dependency through trade, debt, and TNC control. Higher marks reward analysis rather than description alone.	10
26	Climate change: UNFCCC, Paris Agreement (2015), COP summits, loss and damage fund — but major emitters slow to act. Migration: UNHCR manages refugee situations; Global Compact for Refugees (2018); limitations — host countries	10

	bear disproportionate burden. <i>Terrorism</i> : UN Security Council resolutions; Counter-Terrorism Committee; global sanctions lists; limitations — veto power paralyses response; definition of terrorism contested. <i>Strengths</i> : global legitimacy, coordination. <i>Limitations</i> : sovereignty limits enforcement; underfunded; geopolitical divisions. Higher marks for specific examples and balanced evaluation.	
27	Extended essay — 20 marks. Level 4 (16–20): Defines regional integration clearly; analyses SADC benefits with data (trade access, investment, peacekeeping, market size for Mauritius); analyses limitations (low intra-regional trade 18%, sovereignty concerns, weak enforcement, infrastructure gaps, political divisions); considers alternatives (national development policy, AU framework, global partnerships via WTO/AfCFTA); reaches balanced, well-justified conclusion. Level 3 (11–15): Good argument, mostly balanced, some analysis. Level 2 (6–10): Some relevant content, limited analysis. Level 1 (1–5): Very limited or largely irrelevant.	20